



INDIA SEMICONDUCTOR MISSION: India Needs To Do Enough To Sit On The World Table

The government's strong foot forward with regards to the semiconductor space was a much-needed move and, although late, it is expected to herald the golden era of the electronics industry of the country

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Even kids today are aware that there are things called semiconductors and chips. Some of them even know where these are used thanks to the semiconductor shortage that has been rattling the world since the onset of the Covid-19 pandemic.

But in India, this awareness is not just an outcome of the global chip crisis. The government of India's recent endeavors to make the country self-reliant in the areas of chip manufacturing has a greater part to play in beginning a conversation around hardware manufacturing in every other household, something very few in the country cared about before.

The government has come up with an ambitious ₹760 billion incentive to build the semiconductor industry of the country. Although the roots of it lie in reducing its dependence on China, the move has been long awaited by the industry, and thus, highly lauded. Better late than never, right? However, no matter how ambitious the plan, the

industry which has been neglected for the longest time now needs to buckle up and get a few things straightened out before it can dive headlong into the game.

"I think we always talk about three aspects: economic security, cybersecurity, and infrastructure security. The infrastructure in particular needs to be built. It is high time because otherwise we will be in trouble in the future. You need to have a seat on the table," says Dr Satya Gupta, President, VLSI Society of India.

Building the ecosystem: There's more than what meets the eye

"I think that if there is any nation that can emerge as a superpower in chip design, along with China, India has to be there," notes Dr Naveed Sherwani, CEO, Rapid-Silicon. The road to the zenith, however, is a long and risky one, something Indian businesses are yet to be ready for. In our bid to achieve self-reliance, big corporations are